My Journey

As I sit down to type up the story of my life, I find myself reflecting on the pivotal role that computers have played in shaping my journey. From the earliest days of my childhood, I was drawn to the captivating world of technology. The flickering glow of the monitor and the rhythmic hum of the hard drive became the backdrop of my upbringing, fueling my curiosity and igniting a passion that would guide me through the twists and turns of my educational path. In this autobiography, I invite you to join me as I delve into the depths of my relationship with computers, tracing the evolution of my passion from its humble beginnings to its current manifestation as a driving force in my academic pursuits.

My journey into the world of computers began in the earliest memories of my childhood. I can still vividly recall the days spent sitting beside my father, peering over his shoulder as he navigated the digital landscapes of his old Dell computer. It was a time when the internet was still unknown to me, and the only world I knew existed within the confines of that bulky monitor. My father introduced me to the wonders of computing through the medium of games. Together, we would virtually explore fantastical realms filled with mythical creatures. These games, whether they came pre-installed on the computer or were loaded from an optical drive, became the focal point of my early fascination with computers. These were the first steps on a journey that would lead me down the path of education, and exploration in the fascinating world of computers.

During my early education, I followed a typical path. I was an average student, neither excelling nor falling behind. I thrived in subjects that captured my interest but struggled with those that didn't resonate with me. Math, in particular, remained a constant source of frustration, a sentiment shared by many of us. Despite this, my passion for computers never waned. While I may have found math daunting, I remained deeply engrossed in the math behind technology, a fascination that continued to drive me forward.

Throughout this time, I was using computers daily. Some days were spent just playing a game while other days were spent tinkering with the system. I especially enjoyed ripping apart the computer and putting it back together. I was fascinated by the internal hardware. I could never figure out how a graphics card worked or what the inside of a power supply looked like or how a processor could be so small yet so powerful.

Embarking on my O levels marked the start of real computer science education, a shift from a mundane ICT course to a subject I truly loved. Excelling consistently, I was proud to rank at the top in our CS internals for three years and achieve the only A* in the CAIE exams from my school. However, my overconfidence led to a downfall in my A levels, resulting in a disappointing grade. Not only did I fare poorly in CS, but also in my other two subjects. However, this setback taught me some valuable lessons. The first was that nothing could be achieved without working hard. A levels weren't like O levels where I could just get straight As without ever opening my books. The second lesson came after I gave retakes and finally

earned the As I so desperately wanted. This lesson was that I could achieve anything in my academic life if I simply worked hard enough for it.

Fast forward to the present, I find myself navigating the challenges of university life, where many things have changed. Surprisingly, I now genuinely enjoy math of almost every kind, a subject I once found daunting. I had heard that computing degrees at FAST were demanding, but experiencing it firsthand has been eye-opening. Despite the difficulties, I'm grateful for the opportunity to pursue my passion for technology at this institution, and I have to say I’m thoroughly enjoying the computing classes here.